participation in the fissile material cut-off treaty negotiations, and continued moratorium on nuclear tests.'[2] Our national leadership has maintained for a long time that we would work to achieve the goal of a nuclear-weapon-free world through non-discriminatory nuclear disarmament. I firmly believe that such a capability is not for fighting war but for deterrence. But should deterrence fail, we should not be found wanting in mounting an adequate and effective retaliation.

On India's nuclear capability, an article, *India and Weapons of Mass Destruction*[3] states, 'India possesses nuclear weapons and maintains short and intermediate range ballistic missiles, nuclear-capable aircraft, surface ships, and submarines under development as possible delivery systems and platforms.' Speaking about the three-dimensional capability of the delivery systems, it mentions, 'Although it lacks an operational ballistic missile submarine, India has ambitions of possessing a nuclear triad in the near future when INS Arihant, the lead ship of India's Arihant class of nuclear-powered submarines, formally joins the Indian Navy in 2012 after undergoing extensive sea-trials.'[4]

As part of risk reduction and confidence building, an agreement on the prohibition of attack on each other's nuclear installations and facilities was signed between India and Pakistan on 31 December 1988. In accordance with this agreement, the updated lists of such installations and facilities were exchanged on 1 January 2010.

I must admit that the Indian government and the nuclear establishment continue to display the highest level of secrecy, control and maturity required of a responsible nuclear power. This has been acknowledged and appreciated worldwide. Even in the highest positions that I have held in the military, I was in the decision-making loop only where required. In 1998, when Pokharan II tests took place, I was the additional DGMO in the Army HQ. It was only when the prime minister made the announcement to the media that I came to know of them. The fact that till the very end, the prying eyes of the world were kept away from Operation *Shakti* and total surprise was achieved, speaks volumes of the sense of security maintained by all those concerned with the project.